

usage. Its distribution is based on the GPL licence. The software is used for minimising Boolean functions using the graphic method. Its current version available is Karnaugh Map Minimiser 0.4 that is written in C++.

What's special?

The main purpose of using Karnaugh map is to reduce Boolean expressions. It becomes quite difficult to deal with simplification of Boolean expressions when the number of variables becomes more than four. Karnaugh Map software supports up to eight variables. Moreover, it features a truth table and a solution section at the bottom of the screen, which shows the simplified output. The software offers you two result options—sum of products or product of sum.

Users' feedback

With this simple and user-friendly software, the simplified Boolean expression is just a click away. Just fill in the Karnaugh Map with '1s' and '0s' and a single click on the 'Solve' button gives you the output and values according to the truth table. Another great advantage of the software is that it supports up to eight variables.

Suggestion

The software is designed for educational purpose only. It would have been helpful if the software was designed for professional use as well. It also cannot generate a pictorial view of the Boolean expression.

Home page: <http://k-map.sourceforge.net/>
Download: <http://sourceforge.net/projects/k-map/>

Platform supported: Windows and Linux

LogicSim

LogicSim too is an open source software for designing and simulating digital logic circuits. The software is distributed under the GPL licence. The latest version of the software is Logic Sim v 2.4, which was released on July 16, 2009.

What's special?

LogicSim offers certain basic gates and other components for circuit designing. The software includes AND, OR, NOT and flip-flops. Besides, it also has clock generator and Monoflop. The input devices available in the software are switch, number input for decimal and hexadecimal values. The output devices available are LED, LCD for decimal and hexadecimal values.

Users' feedback

The software is easy to use and can be put to use immediately. The software provides two gates designing options—IEC and US. It gives you the option to view the symbols as you want. Besides, there is also an option with respect to the number of inputs you want the gates to have. The software offers two to five inputs for one gate. You can also choose the colour for the LED. The software can be run in eight different languages. It lets you create your own modules. Once created, they can be used in other circuit designs.

Suggestion

The selection panel of gates and other components behaves differently in different situations. The software gives you images in the .png format only; more options could have been really helpful for the users.

Home page: <http://www.tetzl.de/index.html>
Download: http://www.tetzl.de/java_logic_simulator.html#download
Platform supported: Windows, Linux

Logisim

Logisim is yet another open source software that can be used to design and simulate logic circuits. The latest version of the software is Logisim 2.3.2 that was released on November 23, 2009. It is distributed under the GPL licence.

What's special?

Logisim is an educational software that was built for students. It is a cross-platform software whose drawing interface is based on an intuitive tool bar. The software gives you the option to colour wires. Besides, it contains various digital circuit components that can be used to design digital circuits. It offers you basic to complex gates and buffers, multiplexers and de-multiplexers, decoders, adders, subtractors, D flip-flop, T flip-flop, SR flip-flop RAM, ROM, LED, 7-segment display, LED matrix, etc.

Users' feedback

It is an easy-to-use software that can be used for basic to advanced logical testing. Users can create own modules and use them in future circuit designs. The software allows printout of the designed circuit. It also gives you the functionality for denominational analysis. The frequency of the clock can be set from 0.25 Hz to 1024 Hz.

Suggestion

The software fails to load 32-bit counter with a maximum value before reset greater than $2^{31} - 1$. It does not allow to enter a negative value in the attributes panel for counters, even if the default is

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